Horror GUI Kit - Case File

Quick Start Guide for Unity UI Toolkit

A complete horror interface with 16 functional screens in 33 finished layouts. The kit includes menus, settings, HUD states, inventory, journal, maps, dialogs, shared styling, custom UI Toolkit elements, and an interactive demo.

1. Requirements

- Unity 6000.4 or newer. Verified with Unity 6000.4.7f1.
- Runtime UI Toolkit. This is not a uGUI package.
- No required third-party packages.
- Compatible with Built-in Render Pipeline, URP, and HDRP.
- Designed for landscape layouts at a 1920 x 1080 reference resolution.

2. Run the Demo

1. Import the package and wait for Unity to finish compiling.
2. Open **Assets/HorrorCaseFile/Scenes/Demo.unity**.
3. Enter Play Mode.
4. Use PageUp and PageDown to browse every layout. Use - and + to change the film grain intensity.

3. Add a Screen to Your Scene

1. Create a GameObject and add a **UIDocument** component.
2. Assign **Assets/HorrorCaseFile/UI/PanelSettings_HCF.asset** to Panel Settings.
3. Assign any UXML from **Assets/HorrorCaseFile/UI/Screens** to Source Asset.
4. Connect your game logic to the named UI elements.

> **Important.** The UXML files provide complete layouts and native UI Toolkit controls. Scene changes, saved data, gameplay state, and settings persistence must be connected to your own systems. The demo scripts are integration examples.

4. Package Contents

Screen groups

- Boot Splash, Main Menu, Difficulty Select, Loading, and Game Over.
- Load/Save, Save Overwrite, Empty Load, and Video, Audio, Controls, and Gameplay settings.
- Four HUD states, Prompts, Objectives, Pause Menu, and Pause Settings.
- Inventory, Combine, Empty Inventory, Examine, Journal, Empty Journal, and three map floors.
- Confirm, Quit, Difficulty, and Save Overwrite dialogs.

Folders

- **UI/Screens** - 33 UXML and USS pairs.
- **UI/HorrorCaseFile.uss** - shared palette, typography, and component styles.
- **UI/HorrorCaseFile.tss** and **UI/PanelSettings_HCF.asset** - theme and panel configuration.
- **Art** - item art, backdrops, maps, and save images.
- **Textures** - shared visual treatment textures.
- **Fonts** - six TTF files and their license texts.
- **Scripts/Elements** - four custom UI Toolkit elements.
- **Scripts/Interaction** - selection, navigation, rebinding, drag, and zoom utilities.
- **Scripts/Demo** - demo-only flow and screen data examples.
- **Scenes/Demo.unity** - interactive demo scene.

5. Customize the Kit

Text. Open a UXML file in UI Builder or a text editor and change its text attributes.

Colors. Edit the --hcf-* variables at the top of **UI/HorrorCaseFile.uss** to update the full kit.

Layout. Edit shared components in **HorrorCaseFile.uss**. Edit one screen in its matching USS file under **UI/Screens**.

Images. Change the matching background-image URL in USS. Do not remove Art or Textures files without checking their references.

> Each UXML already imports the shared theme and its screen-specific USS. No manual style assignment is required on the UIDocument.

6. Interaction

Buttons, toggles, sliders, dropdowns, lists, and progress bars use native UI Toolkit controls. Query elements by name and register your callbacks.

Example:

```
var button = document.rootVisualElement.Q<Button>("btn-new-game");
button.clicked += StartNewGame;
```

Common naming patterns

menu-item-NN is a menu row, **cell-NN** is a grid cell, and **tab-*** is a tab button.

slider-*, **progress-***, **check-***, and **bind-*** identify sliders, progress bars, toggles, and key binding rows.

Optional helpers

- **HcfScreenInteractions.Wire(root)** adds selection, tabs, value readouts, and navigation.
- **HcfRebind.Wire(root)** adds the rebinding UI. Applying bindings to your input system remains your responsibility.
- **HcfDragZoom.Wire(root)** adds item rotation and map pan/zoom behavior.

7. Custom Elements

HcfTornPlate draws irregular panels, **HcfDashedFrame** draws dashed frames, **HcfSegmentedMeter** draws status meters, and **HcfGrainOverlay** adds film grain and scanlines.

These elements are available in UI Builder and in UXML under the **HorrorCaseFile.UI** namespace. If your code uses its own assembly definition, add a reference to **HorrorCaseFile.Runtime**.

8. Scaling and Platforms

The included Panel Settings uses Scale With Screen Size, a 1920 x 1080 reference, and Expand mode. The layouts target desktop and console. Touch interaction is available, but phone-sized targets and portrait layouts require an adaptation pass.

9. Troubleshooting

Missing styles: use PanelSettings_HCF.asset and keep the original UXML/USS folder structure.

Missing custom visuals: confirm HorrorCaseFile.Runtime compiles and keep Assets/HorrorCaseFile/link.xml.

A button does nothing: register your own callback. Demo behavior is not a production save, settings, or scene management system.

Images disappeared after moving files: restore the original structure or update the relative url() paths in USS. Move PNG files with their .meta files.

10. Licenses

Third-party font information is included in **Assets/HorrorCaseFile/Third-Party Notices.txt** and **Assets/HorrorCaseFile/Fonts/Licenses**. Keep the required notices when redistributing the package or its modified contents.